Prefers-reduced-motion

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Some people struggle with motion on websites. This can be due to several reasons, including ADHD, motion sickness and vestibular disorders. Less motion also saves battery and data.

You can use the `prefers-reduced-motion` media query to stop the motion from happening for those who choose not to see it.

Mac: `System Settings` -> `Accessibility` -> `Display` -> `Reduce motion`

Windows: `Settings` -> `Accessibility` -> `Visual effects` -> `Animation effects`

How to support it

It's like any other media query. The two options available are `reduce` or `no-preference`.

If you're providing moving media to developers, also provide a non-moving variant that they can use in the media query.

The recommended way is to only add motion if the user hasn't set a preference:

```
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: no-preference) { .moving-element { animation: bounce 500ms; } }
```

Useful Links

WCAG 2.2 Techniques - Using CSS prefers-reduced-motion to prevent motion

Respecting users' motion preferences

MDN - prefers-reduced-motion